

BusLink Cancellation & Refund Policy

Official Customer Refund Terms, Cancellation Windows & Timelines

1. Introduction

This policy explains how cancellations and refunds work for tickets booked through BusLink. It sets out the refund percentages that apply depending on when a ticket is cancelled, how refunds are processed, how partial and group cancellations are handled, and how exceptions such as operator cancellations and force majeure events are treated. BusLink designed this policy around three principles: predictability, consistency, and fairness.

2. Scope

This document covers customer-initiated cancellations and applicable refund percentages, partial cancellations within group bookings, operator-initiated cancellations, no-shows and missed buses, force majeure circumstances, refund timelines and methods, treatment of coupons, offers, add-ons, and taxes, and rescheduling as an alternative to cancellation.

3. Definitions

Ticket Fare: The base price of the seat(s) booked, excluding convenience fee and add-ons. **Convenience Fee:** A fixed, non-refundable fee charged per booking to cover platform costs. **Cancellation Window:** The period of time between cancellation and scheduled departure. **No-Show:** A passenger who does not board the bus and does not cancel before departure. **Operator-Initiated Cancellation:** A trip cancelled by the bus operator rather than the customer. **Force Majeure:** Events outside reasonable control of BusLink or operator, such as natural disasters, floods, earthquakes, strikes, or government restrictions.

4. Eligibility for Cancellation

Any confirmed booking can be cancelled before scheduled departure time. Certain promotional or heavily discounted fares marked Non-Cancellable or Non-Refundable cannot be cancelled for a refund. Cancellation is not available once a trip has departed. Group bookings can be cancelled in full or per passenger. Bookings in Pending state cannot be cancelled until confirmed.

5. Cancellation Windows and Refund Percentages

Refunds on standard cancellable fares are calculated based on time before departure:

- More than 24 hours before departure: 90% refund of ticket fare (10% retained). Convenience fee is not refunded.
- 6 to 24 hours before departure: 50% refund of ticket fare. Convenience fee is not refunded.
- Less than 6 hours before departure: 0% refund (100% forfeiture). Convenience fee is not refunded.
- After departure / no-show: 0% refund. Convenience fee is not refunded.

6. Operator-Specific Rules and Constraints

Operators cannot independently alter platform-wide refund percentages. Operators may designate specific advance-purchase fares as non-cancellable subject to BusLink approval. Operators cannot deny a valid refund. Operators must notify BusLink of trip cancellations immediately.

7. How to Cancel a Ticket

Open Booking History in the app or website, select the trip, choose 'Cancel Ticket', review refund percentage and amount, and confirm cancellation. Confirmation is sent via SMS, email, and app notification. If facing technical issues, contact BusLink support with PNR.

8. Partial Cancellation

Individual passengers within a multi-passenger booking can be cancelled independently without cancelling the entire booking. Refund is calculated strictly on the fare of the cancelled passenger(s). Remaining passengers retain original seats, PNR, and boarding details. The convenience fee is charged once per transaction and is not refunded.

9. Operator-Initiated Cancellations

If an operator cancels a scheduled trip, affected customers receive a 100% full refund of both ticket fare and convenience fee, or free rebooking on an alternative trip. Refunds are processed automatically. Operator cancellations do not affect customer rating or cancellation history.

10. Missed Buses and No-Shows

A customer who fails to board the bus and does not cancel before departure is categorized as a No-Show. No refund is issued for a no-show. Arriving late to the boarding point is treated as a no-show. If a no-show was caused by operator error (early departure, wrong location), customer may file a complaint for investigation.

11. Force Majeure and Exceptional Circumstances

Force majeure includes natural disasters, cyclones, floods, government travel restrictions, curfews, and road closures. Affected customers receive a 100% full refund of ticket fare and convenience fee, or free rescheduling. Force majeure refunds apply regardless of how close to departure the event occurs.

12. Refund Timelines and Methods

Refunds are issued to original payment method or BusLink Wallet:

- BusLink Wallet: Within 30 minutes (Fastest option, non-withdrawable).
- Credit/Debit Card: 5 to 7 business days.
- UPI: 5 to 7 business days (Often faster depending on bank).
- Net Banking: 5 to 7 business days.

13. Refunds for Coupons, Offers, and Add-Ons

Refunds are calculated on the actual amount paid after coupon discount, not the undiscounted fare. Coupon discounts are not reissued in cash. Add-ons like travel insurance follow separate terms.

14. Tax and Invoice Treatment of Refunds

GST taxes charged are adjusted proportionally on the refunded fare amount. A revised GST invoice / credit note is generated in Booking History within 24 hours.

15. Rescheduling as an Alternative to Cancellation

Rescheduling is available up to 6 hours before departure, subject to seat availability, a flat fee of INR 50 per ticket, plus any fare difference.

16. Frequently Asked Questions (Cancellation & Refunds)

Q1: Can I get a full refund if I cancel well in advance? A: Standard cancellable fares refund 90% of ticket fare if cancelled >24h before departure; convenience fee is non-refundable.

Q2: Why is convenience fee non-refundable? A: Covers platform processing costs incurred at booking time.

Q3: What if I cancel 10 hours before departure? A: You receive a 50% refund of the ticket fare.

Q4: How long does a Wallet refund take? A: Credited within 30 minutes.

Q5: What happens if operator cancels the bus? A: You get 100% full refund of fare and convenience fee, or free rebooking.